

scale to what is seen in laboratory research and in field applications of the REG technology. Indeed, this similarity raises the question of why the effects are not stronger, given the large number of REG devices and the very large numbers of people who may be regarded as sources. In fact, there is no substantial evidence to support the assumption that multiple REGs will necessarily yield a compounded effect, or that multiple ostensible sources will increase effect sizes. For example, when larger effect sizes for pairs of participants have been reported, the attribution is not to the number of people but to the quality of the relationship (Dunne, 1993), and in the FieldREG studies there is no correlation of group size and effect size. The same general principles may apply to the data reported here. The effects appear to be dependent on the nature of the situation, including obviously subjective aspects, and not on simple physical parameters, such as the location of detectors relative to the focus of a correlated event, the number of detectors, or the number of people involved. On the other hand, a preliminary analysis of the September 11 data suggests there may be an effect of geographic location (Radin, 2001). The potential for serious, objective assessment of questions like these is enormous, given the continuous and growing database, the wide distribution of the REG network, and the unending variety of potentially instructive events.

A particularly thought-provoking aspect of the anomalous changes in the data is that they appear to begin before the major events. Because our measures are statistical and necessarily have an error distribution around the trends and point estimates, these indications must be regarded with caution. They are present, however, in multiple analytical perspectives, and we should consider some provisional interpretations. The major trends began to appear on the order of two to four hours prior to the first crash. Certainly no ordinary physical source such as electromagnetic disturbances would seem to be a candidate. If ordinary waking consciousness were the source, it would seem it could only be attributable to a small number of people: the terrorists who knew what was coming. Alternatively, the hypothesized "global consciousness" that later would be intensely aware might have had a premonitory cognition or feeling at an unconscious level that was registered in the data from the EGG network. There are a number of laboratory studies that document an analogous "precursor" response in humans about to be presented with a shocking stimulus (Bierman & Radin, 2000).

In any case, the formal data from the EGG network definitely show anomalous deviations that are consonant with our general hypothesis. Many of the individual events have results that, in addition to their statistical contribution, also exhibit temporal patterns that are subjectively striking, perhaps even meaningful. Indeed, when we look for further insight from subjective or aesthetic perspectives to complement the hard-edged, scientific analyses, there are a plethora of indicators that seem meaningful. Discussion of these is beyond the scope of this article, but many examples from contextual and exploratory studies are discussed in a special section of the GCP Web site